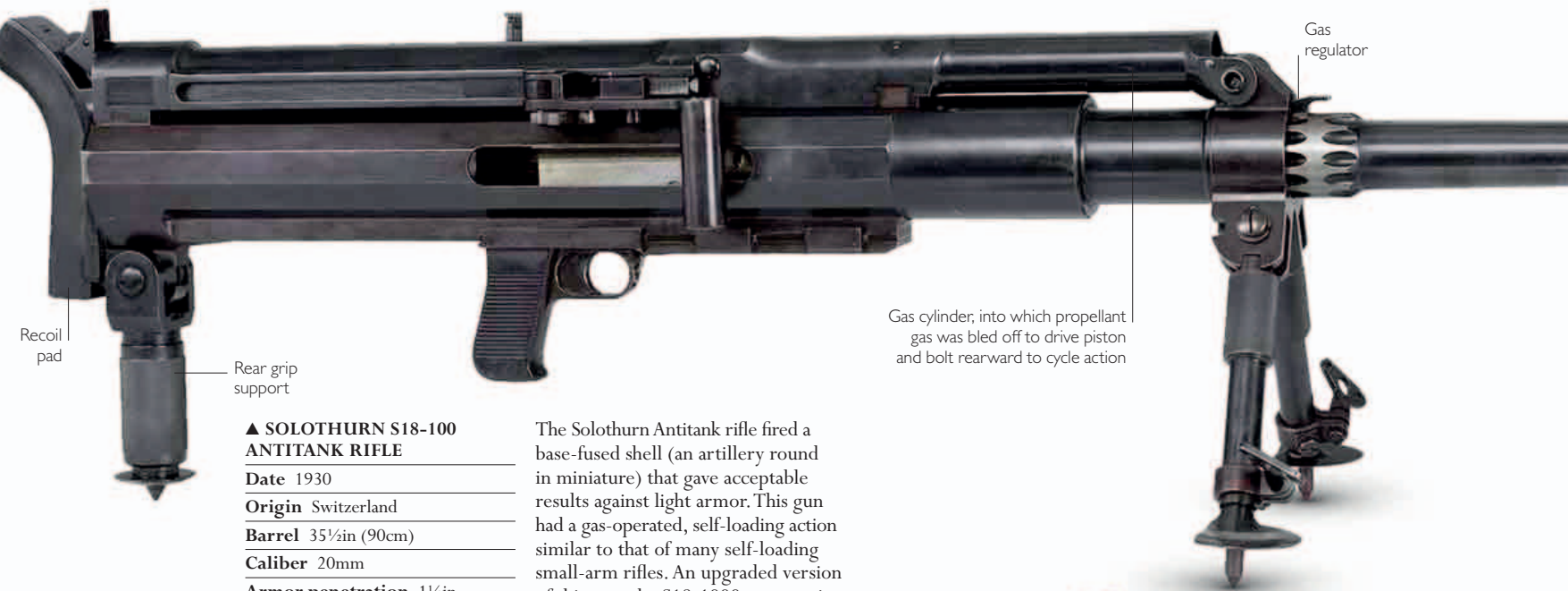
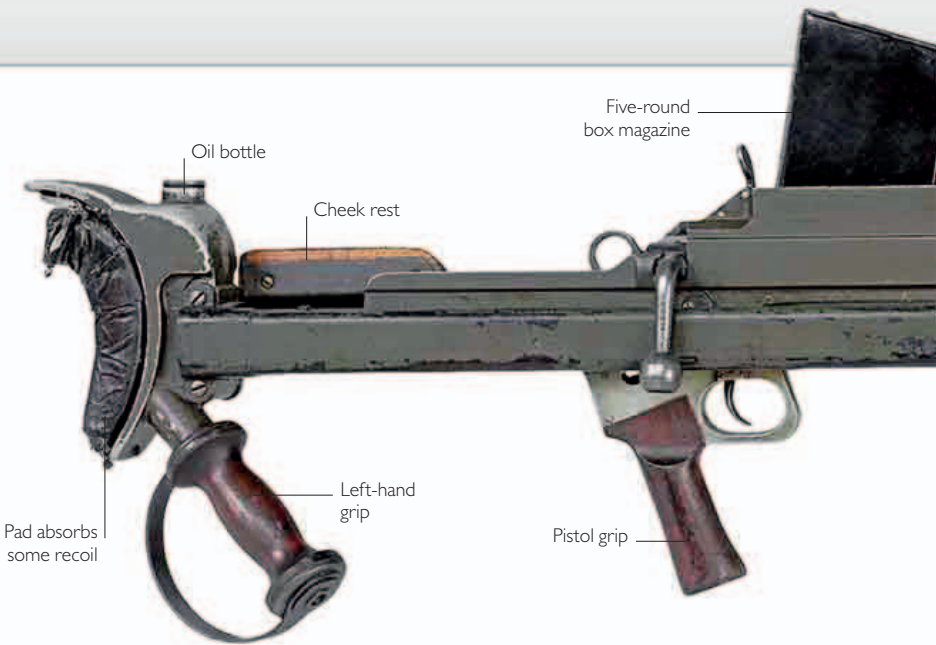


MAN-PORTABLE ANTITANK WEAPONS (1930–39)

The first portable antitank rifle was developed by Germany in World War I. It was called the Mauser 1918 T-Gewehr and was chambered for 13.2mm cartridges. German forces used this long, heavy weapon effectively against British tanks. Antitank weapons required a heavily constructed breech and barrel to fire a sufficiently heavy and high-velocity round to penetrate armor. All of the designs developed prior to World War II were heavy and needed a support, such as a bipod, so that the operator could fire the weapon.



▲ SOLOTHURN S18-100
ANTITANK RIFLE
Date 1930
Origin Switzerland
Barrel 35½in (90cm)
Caliber 20mm
Armor penetration 1½in (35mm) at 109 yards (100m)

The Solothurn Antitank rifle fired a base-fused shell (an artillery round in miniature) that gave acceptable results against light armor. This gun had a gas-operated, self-loading action similar to that of many self-loading small-arm rifles. An upgraded version of this one, the S18-1000, saw service with the German Army as the PzB41.

